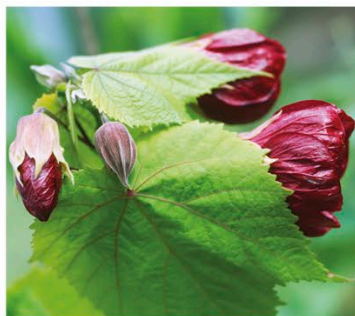




Plants for patios, balconies, and windowsills

Decorative plants in pots will brighten up the smallest of spaces, while containers of different sizes help to create a dynamic effect.

The choice of container plants is extensive, from pretty annuals for baskets and windowboxes, to perennials to make up permanent displays, to shrubs for dramatic, sculptural statements. If the container is large enough and you are able to supply sufficient fertilizer and water, almost any plant will survive, but if time and space are limited, opt for those that will cope with some drought, such as tickseed, lavender, and mealycup sage. Shrubs, trees, and perennials are best housed in big pots that hold plenty of compost, which means they also hold more water and fertilizer; plant them in place because they will be very heavy when full.



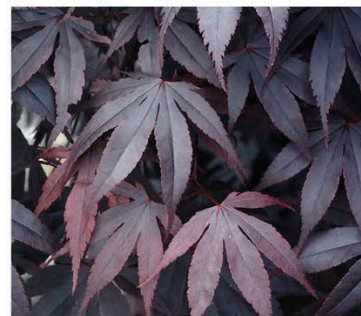
SHRUB LARGE

Abutilon 'Nabob'

FLOWERING MAPLE An evergreen shrub with green maplelike foliage and bowl-shaped crimson summer flowers. In cooler areas, grow as annuals in soil-based potting mix. To overwinter, take tip cuttings in late summer or bring indoors in bright light.

↑→ 10ft (3m)

☀ Z9–10



TREE SMALL

Acer palmatum 'Bloodgood'

JAPANESE MAPLE A deciduous tree with reddish purple maplelike leaves that turn bright red in fall. Winged red fruits follow the small purple spring flowers. Grow in a large container of soil-based potting mix, shaded from full sun. Water well.

↑→ 15ft (5m)

☀ Z5–8



PERENNIAL LARGE

Agapanthus **Headbourne hybrids**

AFRICAN LILY This perennial has strap-shaped foliage and spherical clusters of blue funnel-shaped flowers from late summer to early fall. Grow in a sheltered site in soil-based potting mix with added grit.

↑ 4ft (1.2m) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☀ Z6–9



PERENNIAL LARGE

Agave americana 'Variegata'

CENTURY PLANT This succulent has lance-shaped, pointed, cream-edged gray-green leaves. In hot summers, cream flowers may appear. Grow in a mix of potting soil and grit; move containerized plants indoors in areas with cold winters.

↑→ 5ft (1.5m)

☀ Z9–11 ☹



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Anthemis tinctoria

GOLDEN MARGUERITE This clump-forming perennial bears lacy aromatic leaves and daisy-like white or yellow flowers all summer. Plant in containers of soil-based potting mix. Varieties include the lemon-yellow-flowered 'E.C. Buxton' (above).

↑→ 3ft (1m)

☀ Z3–8



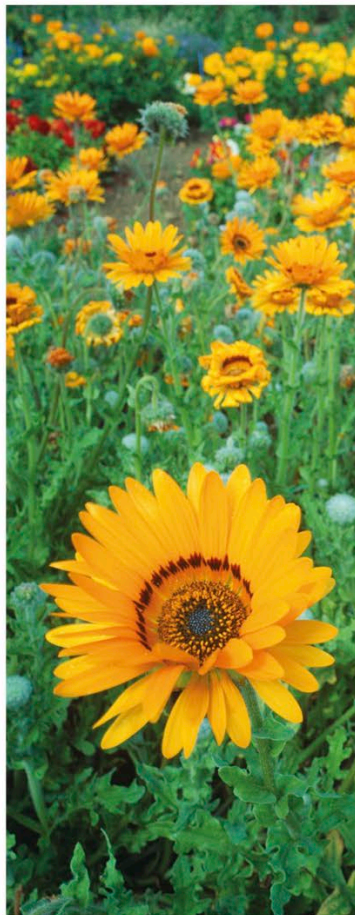
ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Antirrhinum majus

SNAPDRAGON This small upright annual has lance-shaped green leaves and, from late spring to fall, it produces spikes of two-lipped flowers in pink, red, crimson, burgundy, white, and yellow. Grow it in groups in containers of potting soil.

↑→ 18in (45cm)

☀



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Arctotis fastuosa

CAPE DAISY This medium-sized upright annual produces lobed, silvery green leaves and masses of daisy-like, bright orange flowers with dark maroon and black eyes throughout summer. Plant it in groups in containers of potting soil.

↑ 24in (60cm) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☀



SHRUB SMALL

Argyranthemum **foeniculaceum**

LANCE-LEAF MARGUERITE DAISY This evergreen subshrub, grown as an annual, has ferny gray-green foliage and yellow-centered white flowers all summer and early fall. Grow in containers of potting soil.

↑→ 32in (80cm)

☀ Z10–11